The role of data product owner is extremely important, because the manner in which this role is performed will largely determine the success of implementing the data mesh approach. If assigned data product owners strategically develop products and ensure that they are of adequate quality and richly documented, the value of the data available and the benefits of using a data mesh within the organization will be high. A more detailed description of the responsibilities of the role is provided in the next section.

5.3.2 Data product owner responsibilities

The data product owner, as the name indicates, should be the owner of the data product. This person has the last word in making decisions and setting the direction of data product evolution. The owner's tasks should include, among others:

- *Defining vision and needs*—Determining the purpose of creating a data product, its users, and their expectations (e.g., using the methods of product thinking).
- *Strategic planning of product development work*—Creating the roadmap, defining key performance indicators (KPIs) for the data product, and ensuring appropriate SLAs.
- *Ensuring that all requirements for the data product are satisfied*—Providing a satisfying level of metadata description, as well as compliance with accepted standards and data governance rules.
- *Making tactical decisions related to the management of the data product backlog*—Prioritizing requirements, clarifying requirements, splitting stories, and approving implemented items.
- *Stakeholder management*—Gathering information from users and management, and clarifying inconsistencies or conflicting requirements.
- *Collaboration with the data product development team*—To clarify requirements and make decisions on problems that may affect the further development and implementation of the data product.
- *Participating on the data governance team*—To influence the introduction of rules in the organization and provide feedback on their practical implementation.